

Blue Ocean Strategy Canvas

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Create uncontested market space

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Strategy Canvas is the central diagnostic of Blue Ocean Strategy, plotting how competitors invest across the factors an industry competes on, to reveal opportunities to create uncontested 'blue ocean' market space.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Developed by W. Chan Kim and Renée Mauborgne of INSEAD in Blue Ocean Strategy (2005).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to move firms away from bloody 'red ocean' competition on the same factors toward value innovation that makes the competition irrelevant.

FIGURE 1 · BLUE OCEAN STRATEGY CANVAS



Figure 1. A schematic of the Blue Ocean Strategy Canvas as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

Competing factors are plotted on the horizontal axis and investment on the vertical; the firm then applies the eliminate-reduce-raise-create grid to redraw its value curve.

WHEN IT IS USED

During strategy formulation, market creation and when escaping commoditised competition with AI-enabled offerings.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Senior strategists and executive teams.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It reframes strategy from beating rivals to making them irrelevant through value innovation, supported by a distinctive visual diagnostic.

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Trend → Opportunity Funnel · Slibrary 4

Three Horizons · Slibrary 4

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Kim, W.C. and Mauborgne, R. (2005) Blue Ocean Strategy. Boston: HBS Press.

Kim, W.C. and Mauborgne, R. (2017) Blue Ocean Shift. New York: Hachette.